



FILM REVIEW

Not Quite a Century

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Raj Nidimoru and Krishna D.K.
Starring: Boman Irani, Cyrus Broacha, Kunal Khemu, Soha Ali Khan
 In Delhi, all the girls are DTMs (dehati-turned-mod) and are called either Pooja or Neha. And all the men drive cars with windows rolled down and Bhangra music playing at full volume. As lines go, these are not bad. And as movies go, this is to be strictly suffered in a season of photo-finish elections and IPL matches. The sweetest thing about it is the period it is set in (1999) and it's a measure of how quickly we have travelled in this decade

that the dawn of the millennium seems light years away. People carrying mobiles that looked like free hand weights, Hanse Cronje playing for South Africa, 50-over cricket matches and a coffee-less existence. There are occasions in the script that make you smile: Irani flipping the top of his Matrix-like phone and pretending to talk to Mr Anderson. Khemu dreaming of owning India's first coffee shop. Kuber (played with a straight face by the excellent Amit Mistry) the English-mangling goon hired by AGM in Delhi. But it doesn't add up to a century.

by Kaveree Bamzai

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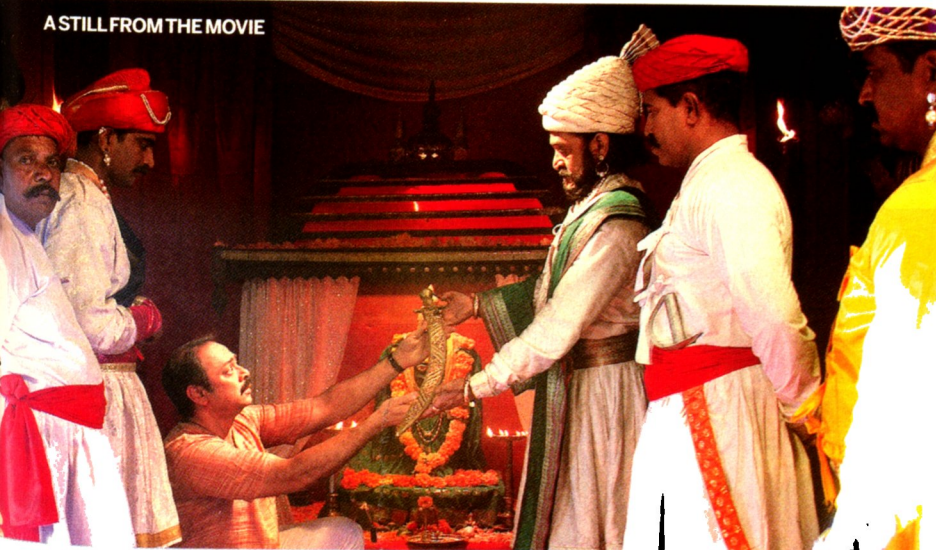
One Man Army

If Gandhigiri from *Lage Raho Munnabhai* caught an entire nation's attention, Marathi audiences are being wowed by Chhatrapati Shivaji's fearless sermons in the now month-old *Me Shivaji Raje Bhosale Boltoy*. Made on a budget of Rs 3.5 crore, the film has grossed Rs 15.5 crore and continues to attract the Marathi movie-goer to cinema halls. Director Santosh Manjrekar throws in the ingredients of

regular Bollywood fare with a corrupt policeman, greedy politician and an underworld don. Protagonist Dinkar Bhosale is a middle-class Mumbaikar who feels victimised at the hands of the "outsider", be it in business, education or politics. It is this feeling of being shunned that leads Bhosale to curse being born a Marathi, only until Shivaji urges him to fight for his rights.

by Aditi Pai

A STILL FROM THE MOVIE



OBITUARY

Masala King



Prakash Mehra

1939-2009

Orphans with vengeance smouldering in their hearts. No-name police informers living on the margins of society. The unsmiling inspector of *Zanjeer* (1973) and the tragic Sikandar of *Muqaddar ka Sikandar* (1978). If Amitabh Bachchan's outlaw symbolised the simmering seventies, Prakash Mehra was the one who lit the fire. The potboiler director with a talent for pathos and an instinct for melodrama was a mythmaker of mass appeal.